



ACTOR

JOB DESCRIPTION

Actors portray a character through a combination of speech, movement, and body language. They work mainly in theater, film, TV, and radio; they can also appear in corporate videos and advertisements, and record voice-overs. Usually they interpret the words of a playwright or screenwriter, working from a script under the instruction of a director, but sometimes they can improvise on a theme.



SALARY

Actor in regional theater ★★★★★
Famous screen or TV actor ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Intense competition for roles • Diverse opportunities, ranging from theater to theme parks, and from TV to teaching • An expanding industry

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Drama • Film • Arts and literature • Languages • History • Poetry • Music • Dance • Mime • Theater • Sports and fitness



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Although a degree in drama, or training at a stage school or drama college, is not required, it may help you break into the industry.



LIFESTYLE Actors work irregular hours. In film and TV, days can be long and involve a lot of waiting. They may work far from home on location or on tour.



LOCATION Actors work in theaters, TV, film, commercial studios, and even in open-air locations, such as parks, gardens, and forests, around the world.



THE REALITIES Actors need to audition for roles, and rejection can be tough. There is little job security, and most actors spend a lot of time looking for work.

RELATED CAREERS

► **MUSICIAN** *see pp. 38–39*

► **DANCER** *see pp. 40–41*

► **DRAMA THERAPIST** Uses drama and theatrical techniques, such as vocal expression, role play, and improvisation, to help people through traumatic experiences or emotional, physical, or behavioral problems. They work closely with teachers, social workers, and psychologists, as well as hospital and prison staff.

► **SCREENWRITER** Creates ideas and writes scripts for films or television shows. Screenwriters may also adapt existing works, such as novels or plays, for the screen.

In William Shakespeare's time, in the late 16th and early 17th centuries, there were no female actors. Men played all the female roles.